

## CLIMATE

The amount of rain, wind speeds and direction, and fluctuation in temperatures are crucial elements that can be the deciding factors for the success of a harvest.

### Sun exposure

Tea plantations thrive when they can bask in 5 or more hours of sunlight per day.

### Rain

Tea plants need a minimum of 60in (1,500mm) rainfall per year. Too much rainfall is harmful as the tea bush requires a dry period of 3-4 months per year to refresh its inner systems before the growing cycle begins again.

### Clouds

Cloud cover regulates exposure to sunlight.

### Mist

Tea plants benefit from being shrouded in mist, as it provides moisture as well as protection from the sun.

### Trees

Deciduous trees are often strategically planted throughout a tea garden to provide shade.

### Slope orientation

When tea is grown on a slope, the incline's direction determines the hours of sunlight received.



## A TEA PLANTATION

A plantation in Kurseong, Darjeeling, India where carefully placed tall deciduous trees provide shade for the tea plants.

### Shadows

The shadows cast by the trees help to regulate the temperature of the tea plants.